Digikon Solutions.

LEAD & SALES CRM · SETUP GUIDE

API Connection Guide

How to connect Meta Lead Ads, the WhatsApp Cloud API and email (SMTP) to your Digikon CRM — step by step, from an empty Meta account to the first automatic follow-up.

1 Meta Lead Ads
2 WhatsApp Cloud API
3 Email / SMTP
4 Scheduler & go-live

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OVERVIEW

How the pieces fit together

A lead fills in your Facebook/Instagram form. Meta notifies the CRM, the CRM fetches the full lead, assigns it to an agent and starts the WhatsApp follow-up sequence. Replies come back into the CRM and stop the automation.

Meta Lead Ad Customer submits form → **CRM webhook** /webhooks/meta → **Distribution** Round robin / least leads → **WhatsApp API** Template follow-ups → **Proposal** PDF by email

What you will connect

SERVICE	VALUES YOU PASTE INTO THE CRM	WHERE IN THE CRM
Meta Lead Ads	Verify token (you choose it), Page access token, App secret	Settings → Meta Lead Ads
WhatsApp Cloud API	Phone number ID, WhatsApp Business Account ID, permanent access token	Settings → WhatsApp API
Email (SMTP)	Host, port, username, password / app password, sender address	Settings → Email (SMTP)

Before you start — checklist

REQUIREMENT	WHY IT IS NEEDED
CRM on a public **HTTPS** domain	Meta only sends webhooks to public HTTPS URLs. For local testing on XAMPP use `ngrok http 8000` and use the https URL ngrok gives you.
Meta Business portfolio (business.facebook.com)	Owns your Page, ad account, WhatsApp account and the system user that issues the permanent token.
Admin role on the Facebook Page	Required to generate a Page token and subscribe the Page to the app.
A phone number for WhatsApp	Must be able to receive an SMS/voice code and must not be active in the normal WhatsApp app (or delete that account first).
Privacy policy URL on your website	Meta asks for it before an app can be switched to Live mode.
Cron / scheduler running	Sends the follow-up messages every minute (see section 4).

Your two webhook URLs

Meta Lead Ads	`https://your-domain.com/webhooks/meta`
WhatsApp messages	`https://your-domain.com/webhooks/whatsapp`
Verify token	Shown in CRM → Settings → Meta Lead Ads (same token for both webhooks). Your exact URLs are printed on the Settings tabs.

SECTION 1

Connect Meta Lead Ads

Goal: every lead submitted on your Facebook/Instagram lead forms appears in the CRM within seconds, with campaign, ad set, ad and form name.

Step A — Create the Meta app

1. Go to developers.facebook.com/apps and click **Create app**.
2. Choose the use case for managing business assets / other, select app type **Business**, give it a name (e.g. "Digikon CRM") and connect it to your Business portfolio.
3. Open **App settings → Basic**:
   - Add your **Privacy policy URL** and app domain, then click Save.
   - Click **Show** next to **App secret** and copy it — you will paste it into the CRM.

Step B — Add the webhook

1. In the app dashboard, add the **Webhooks** product.
2. In the object dropdown select **Page**, then click **Subscribe to this object**.
3. Fill in:
   - Callback URL: `https://your-domain.com/webhooks/meta`
   - Verify token: the token from CRM → Settings → Meta Lead Ads

   Click **Verify and save**. If the CRM is reachable and the token matches, Meta shows the subscription as active.
4. In the list of Page fields, find **leadgen** and click **Subscribe**.

Step C — Get a Page access token

1. Open the **Graph API Explorer** (developers.facebook.com/tools/explorer) and select your app.
2. Click **Get User Access Token** and tick these permissions: `pages_show_list`, `pages_read_engagement`, `pages_manage_metadata`, `pages_manage_ads`, `leads_retrieval`. Approve the login dialog and select your Page.
3. Make the token long-lived: open the **Access Token Debugger**, paste the user token and click **Extend Access Token**. Copy the new token back into the Explorer.
4. Run `GET /me/accounts`. In the result find your Page and copy its **access_token** and **id**. A Page token created from a long-lived user token does not expire.

> **Alternative (recommended for agencies).** Create a **System user** in Business settings, give it the Page and the app as assets, and generate a token with the same permissions. System user tokens are not tied to one person's Facebook login.

Step D — Subscribe your Page to the app

1. In the Graph API Explorer, switch the token to the **Page token** from Step C.
2. Send `POST /{page-id}/subscribed_apps?subscribed_fields=leadgen`. The response should be `{"success": true}`.
3. Check with `GET /{page-id}/subscribed_apps` — your app must be listed with `leadgen`.

Step E — Give the app access to leads

1. Open **Meta Business Suite → Settings → Integrations → Leads access**.
2. Select your Page, open the **CRMs** tab and assign the "Digikon CRM" app. If leads access is restricted, also add the people/system user that created the token.

Step F — Paste the values into the CRM

Verify token	Same value you typed in the Meta webhook form.
Page Access Token	The Page token from Step C (or the system-user token).
App Secret	From App settings → Basic. Used to reject fake webhook calls (X-Hub-Signature-256).
Graph API version	Default `v26.0`. You can use the latest version shown in your app dashboard.

Click **Save Settings**, then **Test meta connection**. The CRM should show your Page name.

Step G — Send a test lead

1. Open the **Lead Ads Testing Tool** (developers.facebook.com/tools/lead-ads-testing).
2. Select your Page and a lead form, click **Create lead**.
3. Within a few seconds the lead appears in CRM → Leads with source "Meta", is assigned to an agent and gets its follow-up schedule.

> **Development vs Live mode.** While the app is in Development mode, only people with a role on the app (and test leads) are delivered. Switch the app to **Live** (top of the app dashboard) before running real campaigns. If the Page is not owned by your business, Meta may require **Advanced access** to `leads_retrieval` through App Review.

Form fields the CRM maps automatically

META FORM FIELD	CRM FIELD
`full_name` (or first_name + last_name)	Name
`phone_number`	Phone / WhatsApp (normalised with your default country code)
`email`, `city`, `company_name`	Email, City, Company
Any custom question	Shown under "Form answers" on the lead page

SECTION 2

Connect the WhatsApp Cloud API

Goal: the CRM sends approved WhatsApp templates automatically (instant, day 1, day 3), you can message leads from the lead page, and customer replies flow back into the CRM.

Step A — Add WhatsApp to your app

1. In the same Meta app, click **Add product** → **WhatsApp** → **Set up** and select your Business portfolio. Meta creates a WhatsApp Business Account (WABA) and a free test number.
2. Open **WhatsApp** → **API Setup**. Here you see the **Phone number ID** and the **WhatsApp Business Account ID**.
3. For testing with the test number, add your own mobile under **To** (recipient list) and verify it.

Step B — Add your real business number

1. In API Setup click **Add phone number**. Enter the display name (must match your business) and category.
2. Verify the number with the SMS or voice code. The number must not be registered in the normal WhatsApp / WhatsApp Business app.
3. Wait for the **display name** to be approved, then select this number in API Setup and copy its **Phone number ID**.
4. Add a **payment method** in WhatsApp Manager → Settings. Template messages (marketing / utility) are charged by Meta.

Step C — Create a permanent access token

1. Go to **Business settings** → **Users** → **System users** → **Add**. Create a system user with the **Admin** role.
2. Click **Assign assets**: give it your app (full control) and your WhatsApp account (full control).
3. Click **Generate new token**, choose your app, set expiry to **Never** and tick `whatsapp_business_messaging` and `whatsapp_business_management`.
4. Copy the token immediately — Meta shows it only once.

> **Do not use the temporary token** shown on the API Setup page for production. It expires after 24 hours and follow-ups will start failing.

Step D — Paste the values into the CRM

Phone Number ID	From WhatsApp → API Setup (not the phone number itself).
WhatsApp Business Account ID	From WhatsApp → API Setup.
Permanent Access Token	The system-user token from Step C.

Save, then click **Test whatsapp connection**. The CRM should show your verified business name and number.

Step E — Receive replies (webhook)

1. Open **WhatsApp** → **Configuration** → **Webhook** → **Edit**.
2. Callback URL: `https://your-domain.com/webhooks/whatsapp` · Verify token: the same CRM token. Click **Verify and save**.
3. Under **Webhook fields** click **Manage** and subscribe to **messages**.

Now incoming messages appear in the lead's chat, delivery/read ticks update, unknown numbers become new leads, and pending follow-ups stop as soon as the customer replies. A customer who sends **STOP** is opted out.

Step F — Create the message templates

WhatsApp only lets a business start a conversation (or write after 24 hours of silence) with an **approved template**. Create these in **WhatsApp Manager** → **Message templates** → **Create template**:

TEMPLATE NAME	CATEGORY	BODY (EXAMPLE)	CRM VARIABLES
`lead_welcome`	Utility	Hi {{1}}, thanks for contacting {{2}}! Our team will reach out to you shortly.	`{name}|{company}`
`lead_followup_1`	Marketing	Hi {{1}}, just checking whether you are still interested in {{2}}? Reply here and we will help.	`{name}|{service}`
`lead_followup_2`	Marketing	Hi {{1}}, this is {{2}}. Shall we schedule a quick call this week?	`{name}|{agent}`

Language: English (`en`). Add sample values when Meta asks for them. Approval usually takes minutes to a few hours. Names, language codes, delays and variables can be changed in CRM → **WhatsApp Follow-ups**.

> **Variables.** Separate values with `|` in the order of {{1}}, {{2}} … Available placeholders: `{name}` `{agent}` `{agent_phone}` `{company}` `{service}` .

Step G — Test

1. Run `php artisan crm:fake-lead 03XXXXXXXXX --name="Your Name"` with your own number (or use the Lead Ads Testing Tool).
2. With the scheduler running, the `lead_welcome` template arrives on your phone within a minute.
3. Reply from your phone — the reply shows in the lead's chat and the remaining follow-ups change to "cancelled".

SECTIONS 3 & 4

Email (SMTP) and the scheduler

Email — proposals are sent through SMTP

Gmail / Google Workspace

1. Turn on **2-Step Verification** on the Google account.
2. Open **myaccount.google.com/apppasswords**, create an app password named "Digikon CRM" and copy the 16-character password.
3. CRM → Settings → Email: host `smtp.gmail.com`, port `587`, encryption TLS, username = your Gmail address, password = app password.

Hosting email (cPanel, Hostinger, Zoho …)

1. Create a mailbox such as `sales@your-domain.com`.
2. Use the SMTP host shown by your host (e.g. `mail.your-domain.com`), port `465` with SSL or `587` with TLS.
3. Use the full email as username and the mailbox password.

Set **From email** to the same address as the SMTP username, save, and click **Test email**. A test message is sent to your own login email.

Scheduler — required for automatic follow-ups

ENVIRONMENT	WHAT TO DO
Local (XAMPP)	Keep a second terminal open with `php artisan schedule:work`.
Windows server	Task Scheduler → new task every 1 minute: program `C:\xampp\php\php.exe`, arguments `artisan schedule:run`, start in the CRM folder.
cPanel / Linux	Cron job every minute: `* * * * * cd /path/to/crm && php artisan schedule:run >> /dev/null 2>&1`

Lead distribution

Settings → General decides how new leads are divided: **Round robin** (one by one in turn), **Least open leads**, or **Manual**. Only users with **Active** and **Receives leads** switched on (Team page) get leads.

GO LIVE

Go-live checklist & troubleshooting

Go-live checklist

✓	ITEM
☐	`.env`: `APP_ENV=production`, `APP_DEBUG=false`, `APP_URL=https://your-domain.com`
☐	Default passwords changed (admin and sample agents) and real agents added on the Team page
☐	`php artisan storage:link` run (logo and signature on proposals)
☐	Meta app switched to **Live**; Page subscribed to `leadgen`; test lead received
☐	WhatsApp permanent token saved; three templates approved; webhook `messages` subscribed
☐	SMTP test email received; proposal branding (logo, signature, colors) saved
☐	Cron / Task Scheduler running every minute

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	CHECK
Meta says “callback URL could not be validated”	The site is not public HTTPS, or the verify token in Meta differs from CRM → Settings → Meta Lead Ads.
Test lead never arrives	Page not subscribed (Step D), app has no Leads access (Step E), app in Development mode, or the Page token expired. Check `storage/logs/laravel.log`.
Webhook returns 403 “Invalid signature”	The App secret saved in the CRM does not belong to the app that sends the webhook.
WhatsApp error “Template name does not exist”	Template not approved yet, or the name/language code in WhatsApp Follow-ups does not match exactly.
WhatsApp error about the 24-hour window	A free-text message was sent to someone who has not written in the last 24 hours. Use a template.
Error 190 / “session has expired”	The access token expired — generate a permanent system-user token.
Follow-ups stay “pending”	The scheduler is not running, or auto follow-ups are switched OFF on the WhatsApp Follow-ups page.
Proposal email fails	Wrong SMTP port/encryption pair (587 + TLS or 465 + SSL), or Gmail used without an app password.

Security. Tokens and passwords are stored in the CRM database. Keep the database private, use HTTPS, and only give admin accounts to people who manage integrations.